

Television

Several different people were working on the invention of the television at around the same time. John Logie Baird developed a mechanical system for the BBC, an important British broadcaster, in 1923. In the US, Philo Farnsworth demonstrated an electronic television in 1934. However, it was Russians Isaac Shoenberg and Vladimir Zworykin who created the electronic television we know today.

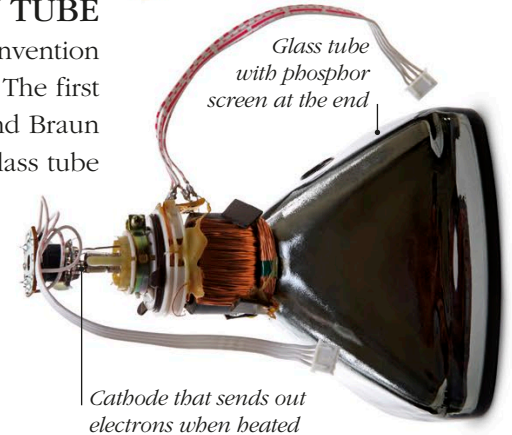


EARLY BROADCASTING

Although there were earlier broadcasts, including the 1936 Olympic Games in Berlin, the BBC service that started on November 2, 1936 is regarded as the world's first regular public TV broadcast.

CATHODE RAY TUBE

The first important step was the invention of the cathode ray tube (CRT). The first was built by the German Ferdinand Braun in 1897. It fired electrons down a glass tube at a phosphor screen, which lit up. Controlling which bits of phosphor lit up created a picture.

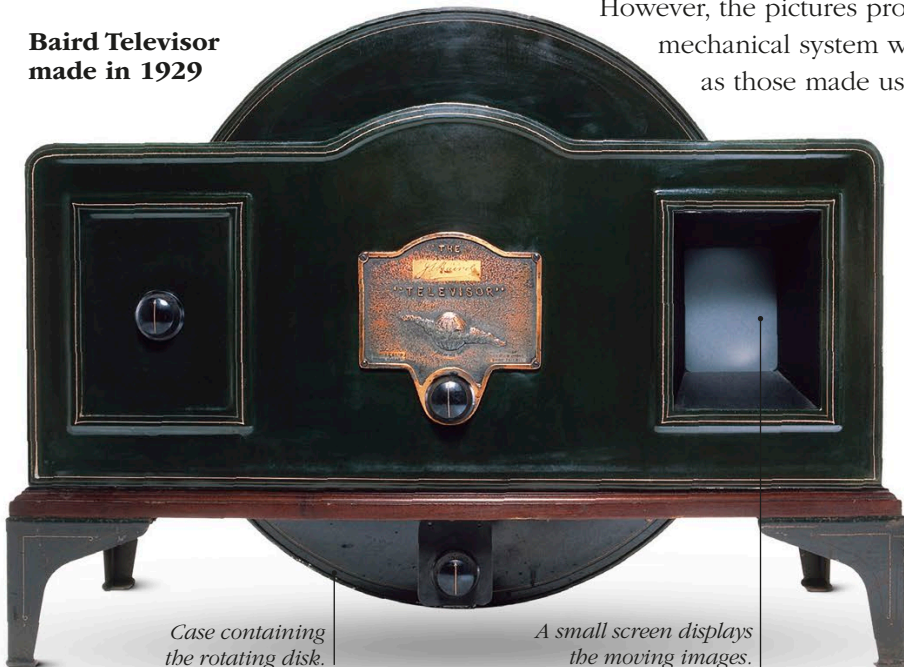


SPINNING DISK TELEVISION

Scottish engineer John Logie Baird used a rotating disk to sweep a spotlight over the subject to be televised, with a matching disk in the receiver. He gave public demonstrations in 1926.

However, the pictures produced by this mechanical system were not as good as those made using electronics.

Baird Televisor made in 1929



REMOTE CONTROL

The American Zenith Radio Corporation created the first television remote control in 1950, called "Lazy Bones" (above). It could turn a television on and off, and change channels. It was attached to the television by a cable. The first wireless remote control appeared in 1955.